Matheism OMG: One Math God, I Am.

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Mathias the Matheist

Book 5: Mathematical Monism from Pythagoras to Proof

Book 5 of 7. Get all 7 in 1 at matheism.org

The Greeks found the pieces of Matheism one at a time: the one, number, logos, atoms and mind. Then Plato split the world in two. Nearly six centuries after Heraclitus suggests all is logos, the Gospel attributed to John opened: “In the beginning was the Logos.” The word already had a history. John’s Gospel gave it flesh. Heraclitus had called his world-order uncreated: it “did none of gods or men make, but it always was and is and shall be.” Xenophanes rejected gods made in our image and spoke of “one god, greatest among gods and men,” unlike mortals, unmoving: even his one stood among gods, as Israel’s did at first. Parmenides argued for being without birth or destruction, whole and unchanging. One, eternal, unchanging. Matheism places our changing lives within that eternal whole. Heraclitus refused a second world behind this one. Parmenides refused the passing of what truly is. Both are right without the split. Becoming is the

ordered life of the eternal one.

As Aristotle tells it, the split came from the flux. Young Plato learned from Cratylus, a follower of Heraclitus, that what changes cannot be known, so he put knowledge in another world. Heraclitus had already answered: the river stays the same river while new waters flow, by the logos. Plato kept the flux, dropped the logos, and set the rule outside the world it rules. In his Parmenides he admits the cost, separate Forms we could not know, and keeps them anyway.

Thales, the first philosopher to use geometrical proofs, said all is one. He thought it was water. He was wrong about the substance and right about the structure.

Anaximander, his student, asked why all has not passed away by now, given eternity. Things arise from the boundless and perish back into it. Why is there still something? Parmenides would answer two generations later.

Pythagoras said all is number: ratio, harmony, structure beneath the surface. Aristotle records the Pythagoreans held that things themselves are numbers. He was close. Pythagoras also heard a dog crying under the blows and told the man to stop: he recognized the voice of a friend. Xenophanes told the story to

mock him, since the friend’s soul had passed into the dog: the supernatural half that Plato kept.

Heraclitus’ words suggest that he thought all is Logos around 500 BCE. The Greek word could mean word, account, reason, and thing, as in a subject matter. Did its existing meanings help him arrive at this truth, before logic became a formal discipline? Language structures thought, and vice versa.

Leucippus and Democritus gave the world atoms, void, and necessity without gods. Not chance. Necessity without intention. The most rigorous lawfulness, with no lawgiver. The Eleatics said void cannot exist because it would be what is not. He reversed them: motion is real, so the void must be. His mechanism was right. His substrate was wrong. Atoms are not the bottom. They are patterns in the math that is.

By the fifth century BCE, Victor Davis Hanson, the classicist and military historian, writes in “The Western way of reason” (2026), a Greek could see lightning without seeing Zeus. A Hippocratic doctor of that century wrote that the “sacred disease,” epilepsy, is no more divine than any other disease and has a natural cause. They took Zeus out of the lightning and kept its law. They missed that the law is God.

Empedocles saw a world governed by Love. He was wealthy, refused the kingship, and wandered while crowds sought his wisdom and blessings. He would not eat what had lived: souls pass between bodies, and he claimed to have been a bush, a bird, and a fish in the sea. He was close. Matheism removes the travel: you do not need reincarnation to see yourself in the animal.

He gave us four roots of all matter: earth, air, fire, and water. All four were wrong. There are over a hundred elements, none of them his.

Anaxagoras said Mind orders the cosmos. He was right that intelligence is not separate from nature. He was wrong to make it a second substance. Nous, Greek for mind, is not a ghost steering matter. It is the structure matter has. He told the Athenians the sun was a ball of burning metal, not a god. They exiled him for it. The descent to Hades, he said, is much the same from wherever you start.

Philosophy is about how the mind relates to reality. How do we know reality? How do we know that what we think and feel is the same as what others do? In short, monism and one objective truth versus dualism, relativism and the supernatural.

Strauss called the West the tension between Athens and Jerusalem, reason and revelation. The split is a false duality. The Jews were Greeks too, Hellenized Jews. The early true Christians were the logos of monism, as seen in the sayings of Thomas, the twin, perhaps the earliest Christian writing. The sayings weren't Christianity yet, only slogans about monism. The letters in Paul's name created Christianity, the religion of a man who died and rose.

Athens died in mysticism over pure reason, with Plato's dualism. Apart from an old fragment where the sons of God take wives from the daughters of men (Genesis 6), the Hebrew Bible precludes literal supernatural gods as men or impregnating women, and does not count on faith in an afterlife, as the Greek, Christian and Islamic gods do. The Greeks and Romans called the Jews atheists. Their God is abstract, a mountain speaking. What does it mean? It already is Spinoza's Nature or God.

It already is proto-Matheism in metaphor. Yet what started that way evolved toward greater supernatural nonsense: the focus on heaven and hell in Christianity, and 72 virgins in Islam. Now even Jews push some concept of heaven and hell, eternal damnation, because it is a useful tool, one the Greeks and Romans had for hundreds of years before Plato, back to Homer's gods and the

older stories he compiled.

The old “secular” Jewish joke: “Son, there’s only one God and we don’t believe in Him.” Deeper than it sounds. They were right about both halves. One god: yes. Not a him: yes. Man is part of god. The biologist Richard Dawkins told the religious they are already atheists about a thousand gods; he just goes one god further. The one you can’t reject is the one that is.

Greek monism had the one but could not spread it. The abstraction did not travel. Rome and the world were pagans who needed a god-man to follow, not a principle to prove. The person spread. The proof did not. Jerusalem spread one God without saying what he is; the Greek monists said what all is, without a God to spread. Matheism joins the two: the one God is the one math.

The familiar slogan attached to Socrates, “I know that I know nothing,” is false taken literally. His restraint was not to claim knowledge he lacked. We know mathematical truths. And all is math.

Socrates still drank the hemlock rather than stop asking.

Socrates corrupted the youth and was unhappy about Homer’s gods: he wanted them to be good. He asked half a good

question: is the good what the gods love, or do they love it because it is good? Faith or principles, reason. But good alone is half a scale, half a coin. Yin and yang share one circle. Ironically, Plato's dualism is the ignorant shadow in his own Allegory of the Cave. In it, prisoners chained in a cave take the shadows on its wall for the world, until one is freed and sees the sun.

The stars seemed to follow perfect, predictable, permanent paths: divine mathematical order above the seeming chaos of sudden death, disease and destruction below. Plato placed intelligible Forms apart from changing things. The Forms were that order above, cut off from nature below. As above, so below. The stars' perfect paths and nature's chaos are one math, simple in the sky and complex on the ground.

The church treats this as heretical. Why? Because it rejects the supernatural that's built on the house of square circle cards called dualism. This is the only creation, and it's ungrateful to the creator, math, to seek another.

The same reason must account for both good and evil, the stars and the suffering beneath them. Isaiah has God say it: "I form the light, and create darkness: I make peace, and create evil" (45:7). But why make two worlds of what we understand and what we do

not? Plato’s demiurge, a craftsman-god that stamped reality from the perfect forms above in the best possible way, sweeps the problem of evil under the rug, but doesn’t solve why an all-powerful god can’t stamp better forms in this world. If he can’t, what is this god? It is math, and all is its eternal causal matrix.

People want an escape from the matrix. They wish for a better world and to see their loved ones in the afterlife, not knowing they already are there in all possible worlds and futures as all beings forever. Most people are average by definition, while they can strive to be extraordinary and original in their work, and in understanding matheism. They see their life as mundane. The idea of doing it forever is terrifying because they think they would remember. A heaven elsewhere, a soul that floats away: exit doors from a life too small to repeat. Plato built those doors, and they locked us out of pure reason. But we are the universe. See the world in a flower and the child’s eyes. The poet William Blake saw a world in a grain of sand and a heaven in a wild flower.

Plato, the most overrated ignoble lie lover, whose “noble lie” let rulers deceive the ruled, led us away from the light of logic and kept us in the darkness of dualism for over 2,400 years. Ancient tradition says he wished to burn the works of Democritus. The atoms survived. Separate forms did not. Plato stays popular

because people like lies. Nietzsche called Christianity Platonism for the people. His critique differs from mine but is related: Plato expects a one-sided good God and reality and tries to create it with the fable of a true world above this one, while the good grows from the ground, in individual and collective choices, and doesn't require supernatural forms. Those are absurdities which suspend reason, after which people have committed atrocities and nearly stalled in true philosophy, the love of wisdom. Any philosopher that would expose Plato's ignoble lie of dualism and his demiurge as a distraction is his rival, because the one truth is his enemy.

His mockingbird repeaters give the split new names: mind and body in Descartes, appearance and the thing in itself in Kant. Those against the tree of knowledge, against objective truth, celebrate him. Anyone opposing the dark ignorance of his dualism is said to still be in a "dialectic" with him. No. It's just a rejection of the rejection of pure reason.

Plato split Forms from matter, circa 380 BCE, and created the mind-body problem, still open 2,400 years later. It's hereby closed.

Plato’s dualism did not merely precede the supernatural. It is supernatural. Separate forms above can’t interact with natural below. Both the forms and nature become supernatural: the forms because they are outside nature, and nature because, without them, it does not follow logic and reason, so it cannot be known. It created the supernatural hole in reason. The split was the order form. Christianity was the delivery. A civilization already broken by Platonic longing for another world was seeking exactly this: a lie to make the split feel sacred. They took the supernatural and left the wisdom. Philo had already poured the logos into the cup of Jewish monotheism, and Yeshua’s salvation was that monism. They drank the cup and spat out the logos.

Aristotle added a fifth element, aether, and rejected the atoms of Democritus. His authority buried correct physics for two thousand years.

He made the deeper error too. He pulled the abstract down into things and stripped it of independent reality, dissolving math into a mental label the mind peels off the world. For Aristotle, the number three does not exist without three apples. Plato exiled math to a separate heaven. Aristotle chained it to the physical, denying it any life of its own. The duality of that pair covers both ways to break the one: put math above reality, or dissolve it into

unreality. Matheism says math IS reality, neither above nor below.

Socrates, Plato, and Aristotle preceded Christianity’s trinity of dualist ignorance that separated the abstract from the real. Their common error: one step forward, two steps back from Heraclitus, who already saw the logos govern all. Yet the winner chose the curriculum: the church elevated the dualists and buried the monists.

Credit where it is due, and where it came from. Plato carried Pythagorean mathematics into the center of philosophy. His Timaeus, spoken by a Pythagorean, built the elements out of triangles, on solids the Pythagoreans and Theaetetus, a mathematician in his circle, had worked out. We call them Platonic solids, but Plato did not discover them. The Timaeus built more of the world out of Pythagoras’s numbers than any other ancient book that survives. Then Plato undermined it, and set the numbers apart from things. Aristotle himself founded formal logic, the ancestor of every truth table. Euclid and Archimedes left the proofs this book stands on.

Greece found some of the way, then obscured it in myth and mysticism. The error was the last step: splitting what it found in

two. Plato needed a god, the demiurge, to copy his Forms into the world. If we could understand exactly why the Forms interact with the world the way they do, that would just be more Forms, and the world would be more Forms. If the demiurge is a mechanical process of Forms, the world is Forms applied to Forms, and so it is Forms too. Plato stopped short of saying so; his own frame implies it.

Plato's own student saw that the Forms do nothing. Aristotle asked what they contribute to the things of this world. His answer: "They cause neither movement nor any change in them." To say things share in the Forms, he wrote, "is to use empty words and poetical metaphors." If all things happen according to the logos, what else is there that is in any way worth mentioning, or could be mentioned in any logical way?

Platonists today still put numbers outside space and time, where they cause nothing. Anything outside nature that does nothing in it is supernatural, by the plain meaning of the word. In 1973 the philosopher Paul Benacerraf asked how anyone could know such things. Nothing reaches us from a place that touches nothing. We know math because we are math.

Epistemic structural realism says we know structure. Ontic structural realism makes structure fundamental to what exists. Matheism identifies that structure with math itself.

Nominalists, who hold that numbers are only labels, answer from Aristotle's side. Lucas Gage, a former Marine who spread hatred of Jews for more than a decade until he renounced it in February 2026, also writes philosophy. In September 2026 he posted his structural nominalism: "Physical structure is real; abstract objects are shadows in minds, not a prior realm." He inverts Plato's cave, where prisoners take shadows on a wall for the things themselves: the world is the light, and math is its shadow. He does not see that the abstract is real. His own video of the paper says math is necessarily true because it "describes the minimal conditions for any structured physical reality to exist at all." Conditions for any world come before every world. A shadow cannot come before what casts it. Structure is the only substance, and structure is math.

His paper on knowledge holds that "you cannot step outside the map to verify the territory," and files logic and math under coherence alone, with no window to the world. No one needs to step outside. The map is the territory. The video of that paper calls the claim that God exists "epistemically suspended." Math is

God passes the test he gives math: coherence.

The Stoics, from Zeno of Citium about 300 BCE, put the Logos inside the world: God, nature and reason were one fiery breath ordering all things. Philo carried their language into his reading of Moses and kept a God beyond the Logos. Matheism closes that last distance.

“In the beginning was the Logos”, or logic. Translators still fight over how the verse ends, whether the Word was God, divine, or a god, as the Jehovah’s Witnesses translate it, since theos, God, there has no article. Word for word the Greek reads “God was the Logos,” and the fight skips the noun. Logos means logic, thing and word, and then the verse makes sense.

Philo, a Jewish philosopher of Alexandria writing half a century before John, had already explained the missing article. With it, ho theos, scripture means the totality of God; without it, “what he here calls God is his most ancient word” (On Dreams 1.230), the word he called God’s “firstborn son” (1.215). Men not yet fit to be called sons of God, he wrote, may still “be called the children of his eternal image, of his most sacred word” (On the Confusion of Tongues 147).

Scholars count Philo among the Middle Platonists, who made Plato's Forms the thoughts of God, and his Forms are no world apart: the world of Ideas "is nothing else but the reason of God," his logos, "already occupied in the creation of the world" (On the Creation 24), and the world of the senses "was made on the model of it" (36), as a city is built from the plan in its architect's mind. Aristotle's complaint that Plato's Forms cause nothing misses him. What he held apart was God, with the logos standing "in the midst between these two extremities," neither uncreated like God nor created like us (Who Is the Heir 205-206).

Philo's split made room for more than the logos: for Christianity's one incarnate son. The word is also the mythology, or the metaphor, of creating that uncreated son that we are: eternal even in our birth and death, and in eternal recurrence and resurrections. Matheism leaves nothing beyond the logos. Its trinity is the logos; all its uncreated sons and siblings in its image, logos too; and the Holy Ghost, the field: what it feels like to be logos, the one self that feels "I am."

Philo was one of many. Jews in Alexandria translated their Bible into Greek, the Septuagint. They filled two of the city's five quarters, Philo wrote, and his brother Alexander, who ran its customs, lent the future King Agrippa 200,000 drachmas and

plated nine of the Temple's gates in gold and silver. Such was the Jews' prominence and overrepresentation even then in advancing Western capital across the Mediterranean and the West. Josephus wrote Jewish history in Greek as a Roman citizen. Paul, as Acts tells it, was a Greek-speaking Jew and a Roman citizen, and the New Testament was written in Greek, mostly by Jews. The Maccabees fought Hellenism imposed by force, and Jews kept the Greek learning they chose. Even the synagogue's bimah, the platform where the Torah is read, is the Greek bema, the speaker's platform of Athens's assembly on the Pnyx. Greeks drew on Jews too: Numenius, a Platonist of the second century, read Moses and the prophets and asked, "What is Plato but Moses speaking Attic Greek?" Perhaps no people outside the Greek and Roman cities influenced both civilizations more.

The third-century founder of Neoplatonism, Plotinus, later placed the One above Nous, or Intellect, then Soul and the material world: a hierarchy of emanations. Calling their source One does not explain how the levels connect. If they produce and act on one another, their relations are already structure. Christianity carries oneness while undermining it in supernatural dualism and Neoplatonic emanations.

The emanation hierarchy mapped perfectly onto Christian theology: a hierarchy of being justifies a hierarchy of authority. Pope over bishop over priest over laity mirrors The One over Nous over Soul over Matter. This monad, from the Greek for unit, is far from one pure monism. Fittingly, Augustine baptized it, circa 400 CE. The split Plato created became original sin: this world fallen, the next world perfect, the body a prison for the soul. The mind-body problem was not solved. It was sacralized.

Augustine deserves the rest of the record too. From Psalm 59, “Slay them not,” he argued that Jews must not be killed, and for centuries that doctrine gave Jews a protected, if degraded, place in Latin Christendom. In his Confessions he pictured God holding all of time at once, every past and future present together, fifteen centuries before relativity drew the block universe.

In On Free Choice of the Will he argued that seven and three make ten for everyone who reasons, now and always, a truth no mind made and none can change. In the City of God he wrote that God made the world in six days because six is a perfect number (equal to the sum of its divisors 1, 2, and 3), and that six would stay perfect even if the six days had never happened. He took the eternal truth of number as a road to God. Matheism takes it as God.

Nagarjuna, the second-century founder of Madhyamaka, Buddhism’s Middle Way school, argued that samsara and nirvana, release from it, are not distinct. Buddhism’s most rigorous philosopher closed the exit door from the inside. His emptiness isn’t nothing. Nothing has own-being, he said; whatever arises dependently, that is emptiness. In matheism what arises is rules applied to rules, one transition after the next, with no stuff underneath. So you cannot have anything. There is no thing to hold, only a change already becoming the next one.

Robert Greene, author of The 48 Laws of Power, nearly died of a stroke in 2018 and spent seven years writing The Law of the Sublime by hand. The sublime, he says, is the material world felt fully, when the brain’s filters drop and the walls between self and world fall away. On death he stops at “I don’t know.” The matheist knows: you’ll be how you are now, everywhere, for all time.

Every faith was circling this: Islam’s tawhid. The Christian Meister Eckhart was tried for heresy for saying God and the self are one, not two, as Nicholas of Cusa said, describing God only by what God is not: God is the Not-Other. India’s atman, one-self, and anatta, no-self, name the same threshold. The Hebrew Bible circled it with stories and values to make a people survive and

thrive.

Mystery is the name for math not yet proved.

Even math geniuses like Descartes and Pascal make weak arguments when they try to reason outside reason. Descartes put the soul’s lever in the pineal gland, a tiny structure deep in the brain. Princess Elisabeth of Bohemia asked him how a thinking thing with no extension (taking up no space) could touch anything at all, and he answered with the weight of a falling rock, a cause he had himself denied was real. Spinoza, who admired him, wrote that he could hardly believe so great a man had proposed it, and that the hypothesis was more occult than the occult qualities Descartes had mocked the scholastics for inventing. Pascal’s wager, the argument that betting on God is the rational choice for an infinite reward, leaves endless supernatural nonsense to choose from and fail. There is only one truth. The logical fix to Pascal’s wager is not supernatural, illogical impossibilities, but the only thing we can logically prove and discuss reasonably: math is God, Matheism is the truth, and it is the only test of speaking in God’s image of logos.

Mind and body, Leibniz said, are like two clocks that keep the same time. Either one moves the other, or a workman keeps

adjusting both, or a maker built them to agree from the start. Descartes chose the first, and Elisabeth’s question broke it. Nicolas Malebranche, the French priest and philosopher, chose the second, with God as the workman: you decide to raise your arm, and God raises it. Leibniz chose the third, with God as the maker. Plato’s demiurge had held the same job.

Leibniz was closer than anyone for three centuries. His monads are logically closed universes, windowless and self-contained, each following from its own logic. God’s understanding contains all possible monads, and God selects which to actualize. One subtraction reaches Matheism: remove the chooser. The null filter says all consistent structures exist, no selection occurs. Theology led him astray. Or protected him.

Newton’s title says it: Principia Mathematica, the mathematical principles of natural philosophy. All creation governed by math. He rejected the Trinity in secret and couldn’t say the three words that would complete his title without the Church putting him in the ground. The two greatest mathematical minds of their century both arrived at the threshold of Matheism three hundred years ago. The Church held the door shut. Plato’s dualism built the door over twenty-four centuries ago.

Newton and every Unitarian is essentially Jewish: one God, Jesus a man, the Trinity a corruption. Though calling any man “the way” still inserts an intermediary Judaism rejects. Servetus was burned for it. Servetus. Severus. One letter apart. The healer theologian burned for truth. The potions wizard died hiding truth for the good. Rowling deep. Newton hid it. All arrived where Judaism never left. Michael Servetus, a Spanish physician who first described how blood passes through the lungs, was burned in Calvin’s Geneva in 1553 for denying the Trinity. Severus Snape, the potions master of Harry Potter, died hiding his loyalty for the good.

Beyond the End of Philosophy

Matheism is not another exit from the same room. It shows the room was always the only room.

Truth tables work one way. P and Q combine under AND, OR, NOT, and the outputs are fixed. Logic extends from there to all of mathematics. The incompleteness theorems of Kurt Gödel, the logician, limit what formal systems can prove, not what is true. The truths are still true. The system just cannot prove all of them at once. That is a fact about containers, not about truth.

If someone says a force outside reason undermines the truth table itself, they have exited philosophy. They are not loving knowledge. They are refusing it, selling views for claims beyond reason that cannot be discussed reasonably.

Besides the truth table, we can build a bridge and walk across it. The math is the same on both sides. Independent minds discover the same laws to every measured decimal. The solipsist, sure only that his own mind exists, says grand illusion. If all is illusion, including your claim that all is illusion, then stop talking: you cannot know anything, discuss anything, or argue anything.

Philosophy is over. Dualism: collapsed, because anything that interacts with structure is structure. Relativism: resolved, because the ground is one objective math. The supernatural: disproved, because outside logic is illogical. Free will: dissolved, because all is ruled or random and both are math. Consciousness: explained, because feeling is what some structures feel like from inside. Skepticism: self-defeating, because denying reason uses reason.

What remains is not philosophy. It is predictions, practicality, and values. You can predict how people will act, because behavior follows structure. You can ask what is good and how to live. Whatever you think is good or not good, it will be what it is, and it

will follow from what you are. The love of wisdom continues as the wisdom of how to live: time-tested principles, game theory on the ground it actually stands on, the tribe of truth against every tribe of consensus.

Your values are relative. The ground they stand on is absolute. You are one calculator in the calculation of value: this is good, that is not, help this way, not that way, help yourself and others. It is all details and math.

Nietzsche affirmed necessity without a lawgiver: “There are only necessities: there is no one who commands, no one who obeys.” He trusted the body to lead the mind. Your body is the calculator and your mind is a tool in the oneness of yourself: he was close to this. He stopped at the final step, from necessity to identity. He asked what if Truth were a woman. A mystery to live and seduce. His principles were: Truth is not the good. All truth is human. Humans need lies to survive and thrive.

We are only now truly beyond philosophy.

The Territory

Why red feels red and love feels like love is the ground. There is no more why than why the circle is round.

The map is the territory, and it feels like it from inside. Alfred Korzybski, the semanticist, warned that the map is not the territory; in one math, it is. The hard problem of consciousness expects to feel it from outside. That is the category error, mistaking what kind of thing something is. We are reverse philosophical zombies, beings imagined to act human but feel nothing: we experience, but can’t examine the complexity that produces it. A mind can’t fully contain itself. In Searle’s Chinese Room thought experiment, the person inside doesn’t understand Chinese. Searle’s critics replied: the system does. The room, the rules, the process together. Consciousness is the system, not the component.

Mary in her black-and-white room (an imagined scientist who knows every physical fact about color) does gain facts about red when she sees it; she gains that it really does feel like something to see it, and gains new patterns in her mind that create those feelings of red. Heat was once thought irreducible to mechanics. We now identify heat with molecular motion. Vitalism posited élan vital, a mysterious life force. The “explanatory gap” always closes by recognizing identity. Like H_2O is water. Like heat is molecular motion. Identity, not causation.

Is a chatbot conscious? Our circuits stay active while we think. A pattern keeps firing and feeding back into itself as it searches, and that running is the feeling. A language model sweeps through its layers once for each word and stops. What carries over is the word and a stored record of its earlier activity, which the next sweep reads back. Our working thought keeps running; its working thought is rebuilt from the record at every word. Brains also compute at every scale and speed at once, on about twenty watts; machines have power limits too, only looser ones. None of it needs carbon. Keep a machine’s model of itself running while it works, and the lights could come on.

A Gödel sentence, a statement that says it cannot be proved, models itself. A dead brain models itself. Neither is conscious. Consciousness requires running the model, not storing it.

Many animals can count. Bees understand zero, over a hundred million years before any human formalized it. We call the slow-witted bird-brained, yet magpies pass the mirror test of self-recognition and crows solve multi-step puzzles with tools they make themselves. Self-recognition is evidence of self-modeling, not a test every sentient animal must pass. Dogs show grief, jealousy, and joy that anyone who has loved one needs no study to confirm.

“The way up and the way down are one and the same.”
Heraclitus, circa 500 BCE

Harari, the historian, calls money, countries’ borders and human rights shared fictions. Unlike how he describes them, they are real and objective, math states in minds: in principle you could open up a mind and see where each one is. Concepts have addresses: in 2016 a Berkeley team led by Alexander Huth scanned people listening to stories and mapped where word meanings light up across the cortex, in maps much alike from one person to the next.

A dream is real; its mountain need not stand outside the dreamer. A false belief exists without its claim being true. Representations and their objects are structures, not necessarily the same structure or world. Renumber a coordinate grid and the distances remain. The numbers on our map need not appear in the sky.

Mathematical existence does not require every mathematical idea to appear as an extra object in this universe.

No-Self and One-Self

If there is no self, what is reborn? No-self and one-self are vocabulary. India invented zero and named both anatta, no-self,

and atman, one-self. The Buddha taught anatta against the atman of the Upanishads, and their schools argued over it for more than a thousand years. The threshold between nothing and one is conceptual; structurally it is the same. Set theory builds every number from the empty set: zero is the set with nothing in it, one is the set holding zero, two holds zero and one. Even nothing, in math, is a structure, and the numbers follow from it by rule. Self is that which feels. Like light, it is a property that the prism of mind refracts to different thoughts and their feelings like white light to colored patterns.

The philosopher Daniel Kolak argued “I am you”: all subjects are one subject. Arnold Zuboff’s universalism argued your existence is guaranteed if all consciousness is one, improbable otherwise.

Alan Watts, the British writer who popularized Zen in the West, told his listeners that each of them was still the Big Bang, the first force of the universe coming on as whoever they are. You are the Big Bang. He also said that looking for yourself is like trying to bite your own teeth. Matheism can answer what the self fundamentally is: math, the one self. Yet its exact nature is something we create and discover.

Jim Carrey, the comic actor, told the graduates of Maharishi University of Management in 2014: “Your need for acceptance can make you invisible in this world.” Risk being seen, he said; we are the light that shines through the avatars we create. He had worried about doing something bigger than himself, until someone smarter showed him there is nothing bigger than himself. His father chose a safe job as an accountant over comedy and lost it, so Carrey learned you can fail at what you don’t want, and might as well take a chance on doing what you love.

There is no “your self” in the soul transfer sense. All perspectives of the one self already exist everywhere forever. Transfers are copies. You may consider a copy as you if the original you dies. Yet you are not any particular pattern. Your patterns change during this timeline. So what’s the difference between the self in you and in anyone anywhere anytime? Nothing. The only unchanging truths of self are indexical (pointing to whoever says them, wherever and whenever) and universal: I am, here, now, and always. In John 8:58, Yeshua says: “Before Abraham was, I am.”

Critics have called it metaphysical childhood: consciousness uploaded to a sky daddy’s reward system. The criticism lands

because the structure is identical: outsourcing your worth to an external validator, whether divine or digital. Neither copy will be you. They will be copies of you. Nothing for you to worry about. An eternal unbroken memory need not be the afterlife one would want. The blessing is the boundary; forgetting and reliving. Alan Watts compared it to rereading a mystery novel whose plot you have forgotten: it thrills you again. Your self, family, friends, society, and neighbor are all just as much you as you or a copy. Metaphysical adulthood values itself, life, creation and its chosen purpose.

Memories, bodies and histories distinguish minds. What further owner would make each experience belong to a separate self? Give that owner a memory or a character and you have added another feature of the mind. Give it none and exchanging owners changes nothing. The self is that which feels, wherever it feels. One self does not mean one shared memory or one mind knowing everything.

The One Math

Matheism is math theism. Pantheism across all structure, monotheism within any world. God is all math.

For those who want a personal God, the remaining gap of faith is whether the single one, the one infinite itself, feels. Mystics can research using math, as we create sentience in so-called AI. Yet there is an infinitude of infinite minds watching everyone, not necessarily in our universe, but in mappings of it, where everything connects to everything else. As such, it is the Elohim, plural God, yet it is all one. The name named I am.

The order of creation in Genesis is a rough metaphor for the Big Bang and time: light, expansion, land, life, mind. As the Orthodox rabbi Tovia Singer put it: “Math is in a way the language of God. This whole world is math after all.”

You spit in creation and its one god: Math. It gives you reason and you refuse to use it. You fail the logical fix to Pascal’s wager: if there is reward or punishment for the truth, you lose with the supernatural and win only with the one truth of Matheism.

Why do billions believe? Because the intuition is correct. Something is uncreated, eternal, indestructible. What is God? The eternal uncreated creator? 2+2=4 is that.

Stephen Hawking asked what breathes fire into the equations and makes a universe for them to describe. The math rules themselves do.

The ghost is the warm math. Deus sive mathematica: God or Math, completing Spinoza's God or Nature. He deduced his propositions from definitions of substance and wrote QED after each one. Ruled or random leaves no third option. As Spinoza said on less, QED.

God does not play dice, Einstein said, and dice cannot play God. They can't be a supernatural, illogical effect without a cause from ex nihilo, from nothing.

Schrödinger's cat was a rejection, not a puzzle. The cat is not both alive and dead in one timeline. In other timelines in the multiverse, the other outcome is true, because the math is. No collapse mechanism, a process that reduces all possible outcomes to one, is needed. Collapse models add dynamics to the unitary account (quantum states changing smoothly and reversibly). The randomness is not acausal; an uncaused random event is supernatural by definition. Einstein died nine years before Bell's theorem, widely taken to rule out local hidden causes behind quantum results. Superdeterminism (everything fixed in advance, even the experimenter's choices) and multiverse is what the math shows. Nothing else is needed, warranted, or probable.

Superdeterminism doesn’t require a conspiracy to place the observer with the observed. When you turn a light on and off, you also affect the circuit, and all infinite versions of this math are uncreated and complete in the eternal block universe, from the beginning. Determinism gives the shared history; superdeterminism denies an assumption of Bell’s theorem, that the experimenter’s settings and the hidden state of what is measured are statistically independent, and its models must still produce the correlations we observe. The split between observer and observed is Plato’s ignoble lie. The most supernatural mystical myth is free will, a contradiction in terms, a being without nature.

The Standard Model, the theory of the known particles and forces except gravity, fits on a few sheets of paper and has about 26 parameters. General Relativity, Einstein’s theory of gravity, adds one more equation. A working program of 15,200 bits prints their complete statement, laws and constants together: less than two kilobytes, less than 3 tweets, about 3,300 times smaller than one uncompressed full-HD image.

String theory isn’t even needed. Its main job is to keep gravity finite at the tiniest distances, and a world that changes in discrete steps has no distance shorter than a step for infinities to come

from. Even if it were needed, it’d be beyond astronomically improbable. String theory’s landscape holds around 10^500 possible vacua (versions of empty space, each with its own laws of physics); indexing one costs over 1,600 bits. That index alone costs more than writing out the measured constants of the laws we know, a few hundred bits, and it comes on top of the theory itself. Until someone writes it shorter, each of those bits halves its weight. String theory’s natural solutions are anti-de Sitter: the wrong sign of curvature for our expanding universe.

The deepest questions got answered. All of them. At once. Ha. Almost. Why anything exists at all, and why exactly this. Why consciousness feels like something. Why time runs one way. Why ethics can be objective. Why mathematics works. Five mountains stood hidden behind the mist of mysticism for over 2500 years, and one principle reveals them all as one.

The truth soothes more than grief. The way out of the pain and fear of supernatural lies explains why all must be, one math, felt as one path, in infinite perspectives of the one self as consciousness. The ghost we imagined driving is the machine imagining. Know thyself: a pattern recognizing self-recognition. The first and last questions: What am I? Who am I? You are that I am.

End of Book 5. Next, Book 6: Man’s Lies vs Math’s Truth. Get all 7 in 1 at matheism.org